

WEEK 1 · DAY 3 · HANDS-ON LAB

Draw & Explain the Shared Responsibility Model

Tools: Microsoft Word or Microsoft Excel · No account required



Time

40 minutes



Objective

Create a visual diagram of the AWS Shared Responsibility Model in Microsoft Word or Excel, correctly categorising 10+ real-world items as AWS vs. Customer responsibility.



Tools Required

Microsoft Word (recommended for diagram) OR Microsoft Excel (recommended for categorisation table). Both are pre-installed on most Windows and Mac computers. No internet or account needed.



Portfolio Goal

Export your completed diagram or table as a PDF or screenshot, then share it on LinkedIn as an educational post — teaching is the best proof of understanding.

STEP

1

Understand the Two Sides

- Open <https://aws.amazon.com/compliance/shared-responsibility-model/> and read the full page.
- In your own words, write down: What does 'Security OF the Cloud' mean?
- In your own words, write down: What does 'Security IN the Cloud' mean?
- Open a new Microsoft Word document. Insert a table with 2 columns and label them:
 - Left column: AWS Responsibility
 - Right column: Customer Responsibility
- Save the file as: Shared_Responsibility_Model_[YourName].docx

STEP

2

Categorise 12 Real-World Items

For each item below, decide: AWS or Customer? Type it into the correct column of your Word table.

#	Item	AWS or Customer?
1	Physical server hardware	
2	EC2 operating system patches	
3	S3 bucket access policy	
4	Data centre cooling & power	
5	IAM user passwords & MFA	
6	Network firewall between AZs	
7	Encrypting data stored in S3	
8	Who can access your AWS account	
9	SSL certificate on your web app	
10	Hypervisor (virtualisation layer)	
11	Database backups on RDS (managed)	
12	Database backups — MySQL running on EC2	

Answer Guide (Check Your Work)

AWS: Physical hardware (1) · Data centre cooling (4) · Network firewall between AZs (6) · Hypervisor (10) · RDS DB backups — managed (11)

Customer: EC2 OS patches (2) · S3 bucket policy (3) · IAM passwords (5) · S3 encryption (7) · Account access controls (8) · SSL certificate (9) · MySQL on EC2 backups (12)

Key Exam Point: Items 11 and 12 are the same task (DB backups) but different answers. RDS is managed — AWS patches and handles the engine. MySQL on EC2 — you manage everything, including backups.

Add a third column to your Word table labelled: **Shared Controls** — then add these three items:

- Patch Management (AWS patches the host; Customer patches the guest OS)
- Configuration Management
- Security Awareness Training

STEP

3

Build Your Diagram in Microsoft Word

Option A — Word Table Diagram (Recommended for most students):

1. Open a new page in your Word document.
2. Go to Insert → Table → create a 3-column, 10-row table.

3. Label the columns: AWS Responsibility | Shared Controls | Customer Responsibility.
4. Fill in your categorised items from Step 2.
5. Colour the header row: select it → go to Table Design → Shading. Use Orange for AWS column, Purple for Shared, Blue for Customer.
6. Add a title above the table: 'AWS Shared Responsibility Model — My Summary'.
7. Add your name and date below the title.

Option B — Excel Table (Recommended if you are comfortable with Excel):

8. Open Microsoft Excel. Create three columns: AWS Responsibility | Shared Controls | Customer Responsibility.
9. Paste your categorised items from Step 2 into the correct columns.
10. Select the AWS column → Home → Fill Color → choose orange. Use purple for Shared, blue for Customer.
11. Bold and centre the header row.
12. Add a title in Row 1, merge cells across all three columns: 'AWS Shared Responsibility Model — My Summary'.
13. Add your name and date in the row below the title.

How to Export (Both Word and Excel)

Word: File → Save As → PDF. Or take a screenshot using Windows Snipping Tool (Win + Shift + S) or Mac Screenshot (Cmd + Shift + 4).

Excel: Select your table area → File → Save As → PDF. Or use Snipping Tool / Mac Screenshot to capture the table.

STEP

4

Write Your 3-Sentence Explanation

Without looking at notes, open a new Word document and write 3 sentences explaining the Shared Responsibility Model to a non-technical business owner.

Target audience: A Lagos restaurant owner who is considering moving their POS system and customer data to the cloud.

Tip: Pretend you are explaining it to your parent or a friend who has never heard the word 'cloud' used in a tech context. Plain language only.

Example structure (do NOT copy — write your own):

Sentence 1: *What AWS handles for you.*

Sentence 2: *What you still have to handle yourself.*

Sentence 3: *Why this matters for a business like theirs.*

Save this text in your Word document — you will copy it directly into your LinkedIn post.

Screenshot Checklist

Save these to a folder named: Day3_Portfolio

Your completed Word or Excel diagram (PDF or screenshot)	☐
Your 12-item categorised list with correct answers filled in	☐
Your 3-sentence plain-English explanation (Word document)	☐

Portfolio Post — Copy & Customise

LinkedIn Post Template:

"Day 3 of AWS Cloud training: understanding the Shared Responsibility Model. Key insight — moving to the cloud does NOT mean zero security responsibility. AWS secures the physical infrastructure. YOU are responsible for your data, access controls, and application security. Here's my visual summary  [attach your diagram] #AWS #CloudSecurity #LearningInPublic #BaseStackAcademy"

Bonus Challenge — Push Your Skills Further

Research the 2019 Capital One data breach. In a new Word document, write a 5-bullet summary answering: Was this an AWS failure or a customer misconfiguration? What specific responsibility did the customer fail to fulfil?

Starting point: <https://www.capitalone.com/digital/facts2019/>

Lab Complete — Mark Off Your Progress

Step 1 — Read AWS page and wrote definitions in own words	☐
Step 2 — Categorised all 12 items correctly	☐
Step 3 — Built diagram in Microsoft Word or Excel and exported as PDF	☐
Step 4 — Wrote 3-sentence plain-English explanation	☐
All screenshots taken and saved to Day3_Portfolio folder	☐
Portfolio artifact posted on LinkedIn	☐

Bonus Challenge attempted	☐
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